The Thin Path

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 6

The shorter path to Reed Creek was thin and raised. The longer path was broad, with room for the cart's wheels. Nib admired how quickly his feet could reach the narrow path's far end. Lark looked at the cart behind him and the walking-only picture on the route card.

“A short path,” Nib exclaimed hopefully. “A thin path,” Lark reminded him gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **bird**

“In thin and path, th writes one breathy sound,” Lark modeled softly. “Let air pass gently with your tongue near your teeth, without voice. Read thin, path, and bath. A different voiced th will have its own lesson; we aren't treating every th alike today.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try thin, path, bath. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read thin on the route card,” Lark invited gently. “Which path does the picture allow our cart to use?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **A thin path is by a farm. Sam can see it.**

“What can Sam see?” Lark asked softly. “Use the first sentence to explain it.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Lark scouted the thin path briefly on the wing. It reached the bank, but it had not grown wider. Nib brought the cart along the broad supported path instead. Both friends arrived at Reed Creek with the books intact. Two neighboring signs pointed toward opposite banks.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write thin beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal recorded the cart's actual route. A short way could be useful to feet and still be wrong for wheels. At the reading bank, the crew needed to decide which of the two signs was current.